

SIGNATURE TALENT

### Marcus Reyes, Turnaround CEO

EXECUTIVE

HIRE

◆ 5

SIGNATURE

Signature: one copy per deck.

Once each turn, you may turn up to 2 Leverage into Surplus, one for one.

At the start of your turn, look at the top card of your deck. You may put it on the bottom.

Hired to fix the balance sheet, fixed it, and now nobody is allowed to spend anything.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 208 / 386

OFFICE LOCATION

### Zurich

OFFICE LOCATION

OPEN

◆ 4

branch only

Headquarters or Open as a branch.

Commit this office during a Stress Test to prevent up to 3 of your loss from its Liquidity, Credit, or Low Interest Rates clauses.

The flag is a big plus!

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 360 / 386

STAPLE FUNDING SOURCE

### Whole Life

LIFE

CAPACITY

◆ 1

Leverage a turn

MARGIN

● 1

run start

STAPLE

▲ Mortality

▲ Low Interest Rates

▼ Longevity

▼ Inflation

Staple: any number per deck.

If uncommitted at the start of your turn, gain its Margin before refreshing.

Lifelong coverage plus a savings account, plus a sales pitch for both.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 001 / 386

STAPLE FUNDING SOURCE

### Whole Life

LIFE

CAPACITY

◆ 1

Leverage a turn

MARGIN

● 1

run start

STAPLE

▲ Mortality

▲ Low Interest Rates

▼ Longevity

▼ Inflation

Staple: any number per deck.

If uncommitted at the start of your turn, gain its Margin before refreshing.

Lifelong coverage plus a savings account, plus a sales pitch for both.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 001 / 386

STAPLE FUNDING SOURCE

### Whole Life

LIFE

CAPACITY

◆ 1

Leverage a turn

MARGIN

● 1

run start

STAPLE

▲ Mortality

▲ Low Interest Rates

▼ Longevity

▼ Inflation

Staple: any number per deck.

If uncommitted at the start of your turn, gain its Margin before refreshing.

Lifelong coverage plus a savings account, plus a sales pitch for both.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 001 / 386

STAPLE FUNDING SOURCE

### Whole Life

LIFE

CAPACITY

◆ 1

Leverage a turn

MARGIN

● 1

run start

STAPLE

▲ Mortality

▲ Low Interest Rates

▼ Longevity

▼ Inflation

Staple: any number per deck.

If uncommitted at the start of your turn, gain its Margin before refreshing.

Lifelong coverage plus a savings account, plus a sales pitch for both.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 001 / 386

STAPLE FUNDING SOURCE

### Whole Life

LIFE

CAPACITY

◆ 1

Leverage a turn

MARGIN

● 1

run start

STAPLE

▲ Mortality

▲ Low Interest Rates

▼ Longevity

▼ Inflation

Staple: any number per deck.

If uncommitted at the start of your turn, gain its Margin before refreshing.

Lifelong coverage plus a savings account, plus a sales pitch for both.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 001 / 386

STAPLE FUNDING SOURCE

### Fixed Annuity

ANNUITY

CAPACITY

◆ 1

Leverage a turn

MARGIN

● 0

run start

STAPLE

▲ Longevity

▲ Low Interest Rates

▲ Rising Interest Rates

▼ Mortality

Staple: any number per deck.

Guaranteed checks for the customer; interest-rate nightmares for you.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 010 / 386

STAPLE FUNDING SOURCE

### Fixed Annuity

ANNUITY

CAPACITY

◆ 1

Leverage a turn

MARGIN

● 0

run start

STAPLE

▲ Longevity

▲ Low Interest Rates

▲ Rising Interest Rates

▼ Mortality

Staple: any number per deck.

Guaranteed checks for the customer; interest-rate nightmares for you.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 010 / 386

STAPLE FUNDING SOURCE

# Fixed Annuity

ANNUITY

CAPACITY

1

Leverage a turn

MARGIN

0

run start

STAPLE

▲ Longevity

▲ Low Interest Rates

▲ Rising Interest Rates

▼ Mortality

Staple: any number per deck.

Guaranteed checks for the customer; interest-rate nightmares for you.

A

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 010 / 386

STAPLE FUNDING SOURCE

# Fixed Annuity

ANNUITY

CAPACITY

1

Leverage a turn

MARGIN

0

run start

STAPLE

▲ Longevity

▲ Low Interest Rates

▲ Rising Interest Rates

▼ Mortality

Staple: any number per deck.

Guaranteed checks for the customer; interest-rate nightmares for you.

A

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 010 / 386

STAPLE FUNDING SOURCE

# Fixed Annuity

ANNUITY

CAPACITY

1

Leverage a turn

MARGIN

0

run start

STAPLE

▲ Longevity

▲ Low Interest Rates

▲ Rising Interest Rates

▼ Mortality

Staple: any number per deck.

Guaranteed checks for the customer; interest-rate nightmares for you.

A

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 010 / 386

FUNDING SOURCE

# Assumed Reinsurance

SPECIALTY

CAPACITY

1

Leverage a turn

CARRYING COST

1

each turn

▲ Nat Cat: Any

Your maximum hand size is 1 higher.

Insurance for insurance companies, because it's insurers all the way down.

S

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 027 / 386

FUNDING SOURCE

# Assumed Reinsurance

SPECIALTY

CAPACITY

1

Leverage a turn

CARRYING COST

1

each turn

▲ Nat Cat: Any

Your maximum hand size is 1 higher.

Insurance for insurance companies, because it's insurers all the way down.

S

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 027 / 386

FUNDING SOURCE

# Assumed Reinsurance

SPECIALTY

CAPACITY

1

Leverage a turn

CARRYING COST

1

each turn

▲ Nat Cat: Any

Your maximum hand size is 1 higher.

Insurance for insurance companies, because it's insurers all the way down.

S

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 027 / 386

FUNDING SOURCE

# Captive Fronting Program

SPECIALTY

CAPACITY

1

Leverage a turn

MARGIN

1

run start

▲ Regulation

▲ Liquidity

▲ Credit

If uncommitted at the start of your turn, gain its Margin before refreshing.

A borrowed license on the front, someone else's risk in the back, collateral in between.

S

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 026 / 386

FUNDING SOURCE

# Captive Fronting Program

SPECIALTY

CAPACITY

1

Leverage a turn

MARGIN

1

run start

▲ Regulation

▲ Liquidity

▲ Credit

If uncommitted at the start of your turn, gain its Margin before refreshing.

A borrowed license on the front, someone else's risk in the back, collateral in between.

S

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 026 / 386

STAPLE FUNDING SOURCE

# Retail Deposits

FINANCIALS

CAPACITY

1

Leverage a turn

MARGIN

0

run start

STAPLE

▲ Rising Interest Rates

Staple: any number per deck.

A third of your Retail Deposits, rounded down, have no exposure.

A bank run makes you discard half your Retail Deposits, Venture Deposits, and Evergreen Credit, rounded down.

Checking, savings, and a free toaster: the cheapest money in finance, until it all wants out at once.

F

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 034 / 386

## Retail Deposits

FINANCIALS



CAPACITY

◆ 1 Leverage a turn

MARGIN

● 0 turn start

## STAPLE

▲ Rising Interest Rates

Staple: any number per deck.

A third of your Retail Deposits, rounded down, have no exposure.

A bank run makes you discard half your Retail Deposits, Venture Deposits, and Evergreen Credit, rounded down.

Checking, savings, and a free toaster: the cheapest money in finance, until it all wants out at once.



ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 034 / 386

## Corporate Bonds

INVESTMENT



COST

◆ 2

YIELD

● 1 each turn

SALE

1 any time

▲ Rising Interest Rates

▲ Credit

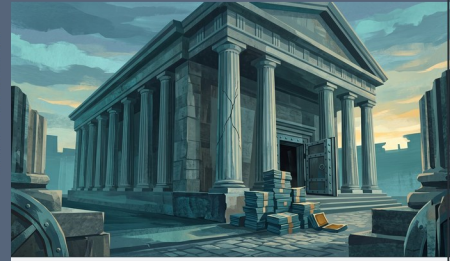
Steady coupons until spreads wake up.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 048 / 386

## Long-Term Treasuries

INVESTMENT



COST

◆ 2

YIELD

● 1 each turn

SALE

1 any time

▲ Rising Interest Rates

▼ Short-Term Equity

Yield +1 while your company has no unhedged Rising Interest Rates exposure.

Destroyed if Debt Ceiling Breach hits you.

Typically boring, but caused the most recent bank run.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 053 / 386

## Private Credit Fund

ILLIQUID



COST

◆ 5

YIELD

● 3 each turn

## ILLIQUID

▲ Credit

▼ Rising Interest Rates

Illiquid: can't be liquidated.

Destroyed if Dash for Cash, Northern Rock Bank Run, or Great Depression hits you.

Marked to model, quarterly.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 073 / 386

## Vulture Fund

SIGNATURE INVESTMENT



COST

◆ 2

SALE

1 any time

## SIGNATURE

▲ Credit

Signature: one copy per deck.

The first time each round an opponent with less than 10 Surplus sells an investment, gain 2 Surplus. Count their Surplus before the sale.

Your forced seller is our investment committee.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 089 / 386

## Private Equity

ILLIQUID



COST

◆ 3

## ILLIQUID

▲ Regulation

Illiquid: can't be liquidated.

Your maximum hand size is 1 higher.

Destroyed if a Liquidity Stress Test hits you.

No distributions yet, which the fund calls the J-curve.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 054 / 386

## Rights Issue

RESPONSE



COST

◆ 3

## SIGNATURE RESPONSE

Signature: one copy per deck; Response: play while a Stress Test is being run.

Gain 5 Surplus.

Shareholders are invited to buy more of the stock that just fell.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 135 / 386

## Loss Portfolio Transfer

TREATY



COST

◆ 0

## SIGNATURE

Signature: one copy per deck.

While this is in play, 1 of your unhedged Litigation exposures counts as Credit instead. Each exposure can flip only once; earlier Risk Management cards choose first. If none remain, this does nothing.

The claims are gone, and in their place sits a counterparty.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 161 / 386

## Adverse Development Cover

TREATY



COST

◆ 2

## SIGNATURE

Signature: one copy per deck.

Requires a P&amp;C or Specialty funding source.

When Litigation clauses cost you Surplus, regain up to 6 of it. Then discard this.

Reinsurance for the claims you already have.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 140 / 386

## Reserve Release

RESPONSE

DARK



COST

◆ 1

DARK RESPONSE

*Dark: Stress Tests can charge for it on your board or in your discard pile; Response: play while a Stress Test is being run.*

Gain 3 Surplus.

*This quarter's earnings agree that last year's reserves were too cautious.*

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 144 / 386

## Committed Credit Line

TREATY



COST

◆ 2

**Carrying Cost:** 1 Surplus per Liquidity exposure you carry, including converted exposures. Pay it at the start of your turn or discard this.

Your Liquidity exposures don't count.

Any time: discard this to add 4 Leverage. At the start of your next turn, lose 2 Surplus.

*The best time to ask for cash is before everyone else needs it.*

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 124 / 386

## Chief Financial Officer

EXECUTIVE



HIRE

◆ 4

Once each turn, you may turn up to 3 Leverage into Surplus, one for one.

*Turns leverage into capital and capital into a slide for the board.*

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 201 / 386

## Treasurer

RISK &amp; COMPLIANCE



HIRE

◆ 2

**Commit** this employee during a Stress Test to prevent up to 3 of your loss from its Liquidity clauses.

*Knows where every dollar is at 4 p.m., and where it has to be by 9 a.m.*

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 211 / 386

## Internal Auditor

AUDIT



HIRE

◆ 3

**Commit** this employee during a Stress Test to stop a Reputation or Corporate Stress Test that hits you.

*Would like to see the documentation, all of it, by Monday.*

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 198 / 386

## Whistleblower

CORPORATE



COST

◆ 3

HITS

Target opponent

Target opponent loses 6 Surplus per Dark card in their discard pile.

After losses, each company hit discards every investment named Shell Company, Feeder Fund, Affiliate Loan, or Guaranteed Returns Fund it controls.

*She kept copies of everything, including the email telling her not to.*

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 304 / 386

## Off-Balance-Sheet Vehicle

COVER

DARK



COST

◆ 1

DARK SIGNATURE COVER

*Dark: Stress Tests can charge for it on your board or in your discard pile; Signature: one copy per deck; Cover: discard it if that card leaves play.*

You may pay Surplus instead of Leverage to play this card.

Attach to one of your investments. Its exposures don't count.

Destroyed if Enron Implodes hits you.

*It's not our debt, it's the box's. We just own the box, guarantee the box, and named it.*

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 153 / 386

## Des Moines

OFFICE LOCATION



OPEN

◆ 3 branch only

**Headquarters or Open** as a branch.

At the start of your turn, gain 1 Surplus for every 4 Life or Annuity funding sources you control, rounded down.

At the start of your turn, if you control a Life or Annuity funding source and a Private Credit Fund, gain 1 Surplus (once, regardless of copies).

*Long lives, long loans, and a very short commute.*

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 363 / 386

## Risk Analytics Desk

DATA



PRICE

◆ 1

Once each turn, after you play a treaty or cover, your next investment this turn costs 1 less Leverage (minimum 1).

*A smaller downside leaves room for the next idea.*

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 383 / 386

## Risk Analytics Desk

DATA



PRICE

◆ 1

Once each turn, after you play a treaty or cover, your next investment this turn costs 1 less Leverage (minimum 1).

*A smaller downside leaves room for the next idea.*

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 383 / 386

## Contingency Plan

RESPONSE



COST

◆ 1

## RESPONSE

*Response: or draw on your turn.*

Choose one; discard this after use.

On your turn: draw 2 cards, then discard 1. OR as a Response:

Prevent up to 4 loss to you from this Stress Test.

*Useful today. Possibly indispensable tomorrow.*

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 174 / 386

## Contingency Plan

RESPONSE



COST

◆ 1

## RESPONSE

*Response: or draw on your turn.*

Choose one; discard this after use.

On your turn: draw 2 cards, then discard 1. OR as a Response:

Prevent up to 4 loss to you from this Stress Test.

*Useful today. Possibly indispensable tomorrow.*

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 174 / 386

## Scenario Rehearsal

ACTION · YOUR TURN



COST

◆ 2

## SIGNATURE

*Signature: one copy per deck.*

On your turn, privately look at the next 2 shared pile cards. Return them in either order, then discard this. Developing and delayed Stress Tests still happen first.

*The disasters are still coming. The order is negotiable.*

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 175 / 386

## Emergency Run-Off

RESPONSE



COST

◆ 0

## RESPONSE

*Response: play while a Stress Test is being run.*

Before taking loss, discard an uncommitted funding source with capacity, and its covers. Keep at least one capacity source. No new funding next turn. Once per company per resolution; stages and replays are separate.

*Save the company. Give up part of the business.*

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 176 / 386

## Emergency Run-Off

RESPONSE



COST

◆ 0

## RESPONSE

*Response: play while a Stress Test is being run.*

Before taking loss, discard an uncommitted funding source with capacity, and its covers. Keep at least one capacity source. No new funding next turn. Once per company per resolution; stages and replays are separate.

*Save the company. Give up part of the business.*

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 176 / 386

## Chainsaw AI at Sunbeam

CORPORATE · AS-IF REPLAY, 1996



HITS

Every company

## SIGNATURE

*Signature: one copy per deck.*

Every company loses 3 Surplus. Then each company fires each of its employees with Hire 3 or less.

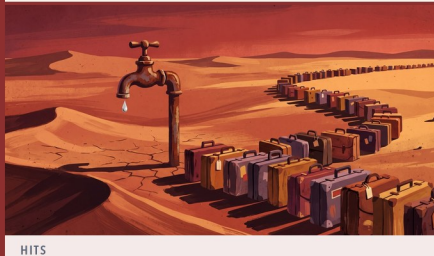
*In 1996, Sunbeam hired AI Dunlap, known as Chainsaw AI, who cut half its workforce; the profits that followed later had to be restated.*

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 286 / 386

## Dash for Cash

LIQUIDITY · AS-IF REPLAY, 2020



HITS

Every company

## SIGNATURE

▲ Liquidity ▲ Short-Term Equity ▲ Credit ▲ Volatility

*Signature: one copy per deck.*

Every company loses 3 Surplus per Liquidity exposure, 3 per Short-Term Equity exposure, 3 per Credit exposure, and 2 per Volatility exposure.

After losses, each company hit discards every investment named Private Credit Fund it controls.

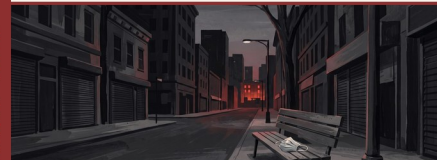
*In March 2020, investors sold almost everything, even U.S. Treasuries, to raise cash, until the Federal Reserve stepped in.*

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 276 / 386

## COVID-19

MORTALITY · AS-IF REPLAY, 2020



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE ACT OF GOD DEVELOPING EVENT  
▲ Short-Term Equity ▲ Liquidity ▲ Volatility ▲ Mortality  
▲ Health Price ▲ Inflation ▲ Rising Interest Rates

*Signature: one copy per deck; Act of God: can't be stopped; Developing Event: all stages this round, each with a response window.*

**Stage 1.** Every company loses 8 Surplus per Short-Term Equity exposure, 4 per Liquidity exposure, and 4 per Volatility exposure. Then each company removes all its branches from the game. Then each company gains 4 Surplus if its Headquarters is Fully Remote.

**Stage 2.** Every company loses 4 Surplus per Mortality exposure and 4 per Health Price exposure.

**Stage 3.** Every company loses 8 Surplus per Inflation exposure and 4 per Rising Interest Rates exposure.

After Stage 1 losses, each company hit discards every investment named Cat Bond - Mortality it controls.

*The COVID-19 pandemic spread worldwide in 2020, shut down much of the global economy, and killed millions of people. It arrived as three crises in a row, and every one of them was on someone's risk register.*

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 246 / 386

## World War III

GEOPOLITICAL



HITS

Every company

**SIGNATURE**

**ACT OF GOD**

▲ Inflation

▲ Mortality

▲ Long-Term Equity

▲ Short-Term Equity

▲ Property Value

Signature: one copy per deck; Act of God: can't be stopped.

Every company loses 6 Surplus per Inflation exposure, 6 per Mortality exposure, 6 per Long-Term Equity exposure, 6 per Short-Term Equity exposure, and 6 per Property Value exposure, plus 6 more.

"I know not with what weapons World War III will be fought, but World War IV will be fought with sticks and stones." —Albert Einstein

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 278 / 386

## Flash Crash

MARKET · AS-IF REPLAY, 2010



HITS

Every company

**SIGNATURE**

**ACT OF GOD**

▲ Short-Term Equity

▲ Volatility

Signature: one copy per deck; Act of God: can't be stopped.

Every company loses 6 Surplus per Short-Term Equity exposure and 2 per Volatility exposure.

After losses, each company hit discards every investment named Meme Stock it controls.

On May 6, 2010, a burst of automated selling briefly wiped about a trillion dollars off the value of U.S. stocks. The Dow fell almost 1,000 points in minutes, then mostly came back.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 290 / 386

## Morris Worm

CYBER · AS-IF REPLAY, 1988



HITS

Every company

**SIGNATURE**

▲ Cyber

▲ Short-Term Equity

Signature: one copy per deck.

Every company loses 8 Surplus per Cyber exposure and 4 per Short-Term Equity exposure. Then each company discards a card.

In November 1988, a graduate student's self-copying program ran out of control and crashed about a tenth of the computers on the internet. The internet was smaller then.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 266 / 386

## Bird Flu Pandemic

MORTALITY



HITS

Every company

**SIGNATURE**

**ACT OF GOD**

▲ Mortality

▲ Health Price

Signature: one copy per deck; Act of God: can't be stopped.

Every company loses 8 Surplus per Mortality exposure and 4 per Health Price exposure.

After losses, each company hit discards every investment named Cat Bond - Mortality it controls.

Talk about a viral tweet!

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 248 / 386

## AI Bubble Bursts

MARKET



HITS

Every company

**SIGNATURE**

▲ Long-Term Equity

▲ Short-Term Equity

▲ Volatility

Signature: one copy per deck.

Every company loses 8 Surplus per Long-Term Equity exposure, 4 per Short-Term Equity exposure, and 2 per Volatility exposure.

After losses, each company hit discards every AI card and every investment named Meme Stock it controls.

It was three laptops in a trench coat the whole time.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 271 / 386

## 1973 Oil Crisis

INFLATION · AS-IF REPLAY, 1973



HITS

Every company

**SIGNATURE**

▲ Inflation

▲ Short-Term Equity

▲ Rising Interest Rates

Signature: one copy per deck.

Every company loses 8 Surplus per Inflation exposure, 4 per Short-Term Equity exposure, and 4 per Rising Interest Rates exposure.

In October 1973, Arab oil producers cut off exports to the United States and other countries, quadrupling oil prices and setting off years of high inflation.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 268 / 386

## Volcker Shock

RATES · AS-IF REPLAY, 1979



HITS

Every company

**SIGNATURE**

▲ Rising Interest Rates

▲ Liquidity

▲ Volatility

Signature: one copy per deck.

Every company loses 6 Surplus per Rising Interest Rates exposure, 2 per Liquidity exposure, and 2 per Volatility exposure.

In October 1979 the Federal Reserve let short-term rates climb toward 20% to break inflation, and the savings and loans that had funded 30-year mortgages with passbook savings never recovered.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 308 / 386

## Zero-Commission Price War

MARKET · AS-IF REPLAY, 2019



HITS

Every company

**SIGNATURE**

Signature: one copy per deck.

Every company loses 2 Surplus. Then each company commits 2 of its available funding sources.

On October 1, 2019, Charles Schwab cut its online stock trading commissions to zero, and its biggest rivals matched within days.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 293 / 386

## 2003 European Heat Wave

MORTALITY · AS-IF REPLAY, 2003



HITS

Every company

**SIGNATURE**

**ACT OF GOD**

▲ Mortality

▲ Health Price

Signature: one copy per deck; Act of God: can't be stopped.

Every company loses 4 Surplus per Mortality exposure and 4 per Health Price exposure.

In the summer of 2003, a heat wave killed more than 70,000 people across Europe, most of them elderly. The forecast called it a week in advance, and the emergency rooms filled anyway.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 240 / 386

# AWS S3 Outage

CYBER · AS-IF REPLAY, 2017



HITS  
Every company

SIGNATURE  
▲ Cyber

Signature: one copy per deck.  
Every company loses 6 Surplus per Cyber exposure, plus 3 more. Then each company discards a card.  
On February 28, 2017, a mistyped command knocked Amazon's S3 storage offline for about four hours, and Amazon's status page could not show it, because it ran on S3.

# Iowa Derecho

NAT CAT · AS-IF REPLAY, 2020



HITS  
Every company

SIGNATURE ACT OF GOD  
▲ Nat Cat

Signature: one copy per deck; Act of God: can't be stopped.  
Every company loses 2 Surplus per Nat Cat exposure.  
On August 10, 2020, a derecho crossed Iowa with winds up to 140 mph, flattening corn, grain bins, and most of the trees in Cedar Rapids.

# Cape Wind Abandoned

MARKET · AS-IF REPLAY, 2017



HITS  
Every company

SIGNATURE  
▲ Long-Term Equity

Signature: one copy per deck.  
Every company loses 10 Surplus per Long-Term Equity exposure.  
In December 2017, after sixteen years of fights with its neighbors, the company behind Cape Wind, planned as America's first offshore wind farm, gave up. Nothing got built.

# Klarna's Down Round

MARKET · AS-IF REPLAY, 2022



HITS  
Every company

SIGNATURE  
▲ Credit

Signature: one copy per deck.  
Every company loses 5 Surplus per Credit exposure.  
In July 2022, Klarna, Europe's biggest buy now, pay later lender, raised money at a valuation 85% below its peak a year earlier. Four easy payments, then the fifth, the sixth, and the collections calls.